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Evaluation of a Community-Based Participatory Model of Family Education

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NAZ CONNECT. EXPECT. SUCCEED. A Promise Neighborhood

Background

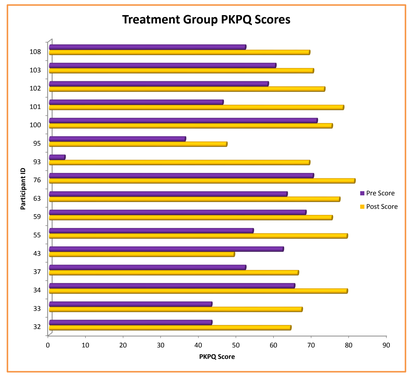
Family Academy: College Bound Babies (CBB) is a section of the Family Academy program within the Northside Achievement Zone's (NAZ) of Minneapolis "cradle to career" pipeline. NAZ is a zone-based approach to building a continuum of educational and social support for children, birth to age 18, and their families, ensuring all children in the NAZ are college-ready. In December 2011, NAZ was awarded a 28 million dollar Promise Neighborhoods grant from the federal government to support expansion and evaluation of its model. CBB plays a large role in this expansion, as it is the most prominent evidence-based support offered to families by the NAZ, and as such, NAZ is highly invested in its success.

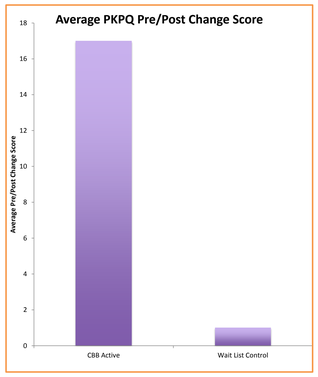
CBB is a promising parent education model for low-income, parents of children 0-3 years old who live in a geographic zone in Minneapolis characterized by low school readiness rates, a wide educational achievement gap, high poverty, and high rates of family and community violence. It is a unique model, developed through a grassroots community-engaged process with participants, practitioners and researchers.

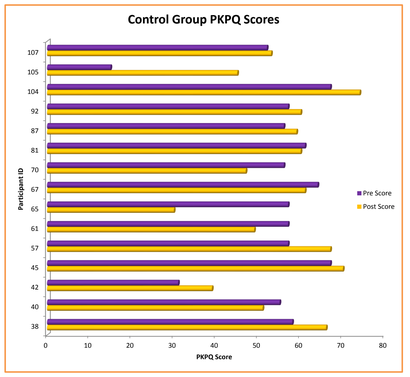
Methodology

The evaluation of CBB examines change in parent knowledge and practices that closely aligns with curricular components. This measurement model diverges from the traditional focus on distal measures of the target construct, to specifically evaluate the degree to which parents receiving the intervention actually demonstrate increased use of the behavior within their daily lives (Slavin & Madden, 2011). Further, as this project is strongly rooted in a community-based participatory approach (Minkler & Wallerstein, 2011), NAZ program staff are an integral component of measure and measurement model development. NAZ program staff provide direct input on the design and wording of items and data collection methodology to increase the likelihood that the measures stay culturally relevant and solicited information in a meaningful and valid way from participants.

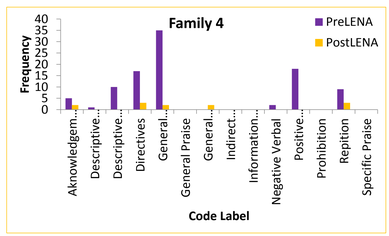
Results

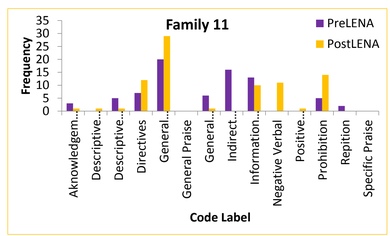


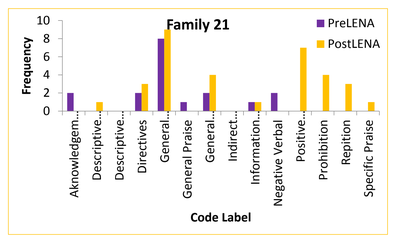


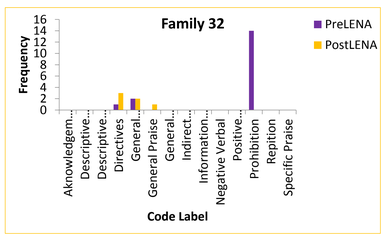


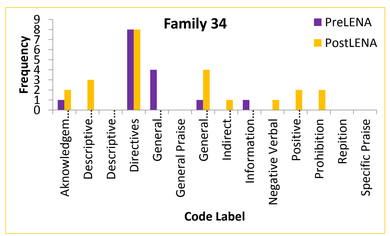
On average, the active Family Academy participants gained 17 points on the PKPQ from pre-test to post-test. Wait List Control families gained, on average 1 point on the PKPQ from pre-test to post-test. This difference is significant, t = 2.893, p = .01.

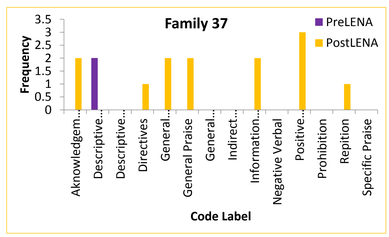


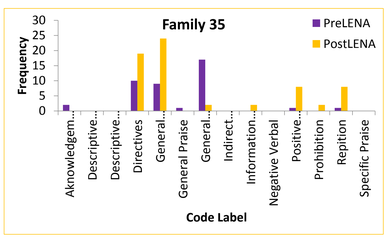


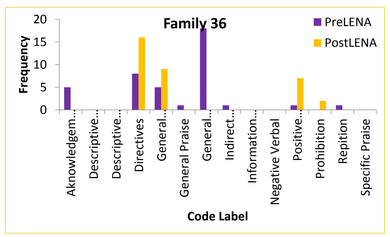












Measures: PKPQ and LENA

LENA

The Language ENvironment Analysis (LENA) is a cutting-edge technology system used to gather and analyze data in a child's home language environment via audio recordings. It consists of a digital language processor (DLP) and speech recognition software. Children wear the DLP in the pocket of custom-made clothing and the system records all audio data occurring in the home for up to 16 hours. LENA recordings were conducted twice during the CBB session: once within the two week period prior to the start of the program and once within a month of the end of the program.



Of the 16 hour audio file, two five minute segments of audio data (with parameters for sampling standardized across participants) were selected, transcribed, and coded using the Parent Language Behavior Code (PLBC), developed by the research team. The PLBC has been developed to capture the frequency with which specific language behaviors directly taught within the CBB curriculum are occurring in the home environment.

PKPQ

The Parent Knowledge and Practices Questionnaire (PKPQ) consists of approximately 32 items that are either short answer, which reflect parents' level of knowledge on positive parenting practices, and rating scale items that ask parents to rate their typical use of specific parenting practices specifically taught by the CBB Curriculum.

Minkler, M., & Wallerstein, N. (Eds.). (2011). *Community-based participatory research for health: From process to outcomes*. Jossey-Bass.
Slavin, R. & Madden, N. (2011): Measures Inherent to Treatments in Program Effectiveness Reviews, Journal of Research on Educational Effectiveness, 4:4, 370-380

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